



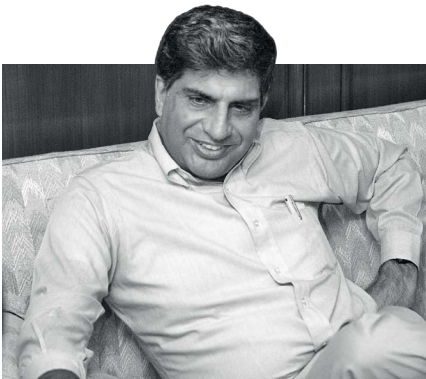
In 2004, the board of Tata Steel convened at the group's iconic Bombay House headquarters for what seemed like a regular meeting. It was soon after the buyout of Singapore's NatSteel and was viewed as an important step in the company's journey of going global. But one person did not seem too pleased: Ratan

Naval Tata (RNT), Chairman of Tata Sons.

"Why are we making these small acquisitions?" he asked about a deal worth a sizeable \$285 million. It was a clear indication that RNT desired to make the com-

pany a global force to reckon with. "Let's do something bigger," he said then. Three years later, it became clear just what RNT meant. Tata Steel acquired Corus, which was four times its size, for a whopping \$12 billion after an intense bidding battle. With that one stroke, it became the largest outbound buyout by an Indian company. That and other foreign acquisitions made clear that RNT's vision stretched much beyond India's borders.

But it was not always so. By the late 1980s, there was speculation about the successor of the legendary J.R.D. Tata, who had headed the group for half a century. Many names did the rounds, including that of Nusli Wadia, the promoter of Bombay Dyeing, apart from several profes-



1974 Appointed director on Tata Sons' board

1998
Launches Tata Indica

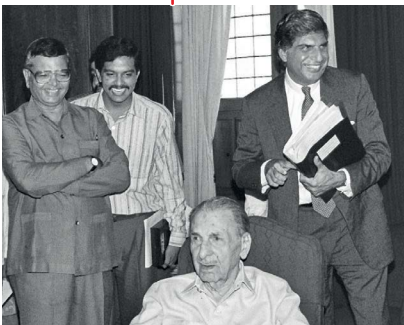


2007
Tata Steel picks up Corus for \$12 billion



Dec 28, 1937
Born in Mumbai

1962
Joins Tata group



March 25, 1991
Succeeds JRD as Tata Sons' Chairman

2000
Tata Tea acquires London-based Tetley for \$431 million



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